

GOLDEN QUARTER 2026

5 Golden Quarter **Google** **Ads** Tactics for **Q4**

A practical playbook for e-commerce brands that want to turn peak-season ad spend into a high-margin acquisition engine — covering feed segmentation, curated bundles and disciplined bidding.



£3M

ANNUAL AD
SPEND MANAGED



1,200%

BEST CLIENT
LIFETIME ROAS



32

BUSINESSES
SCALED

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Introduction

The Golden Quarter offers peak demand, but rising ad costs can quickly erode standard campaign margins. To scale profitably, e-commerce brands require a more strategic paid media approach.

You will unlock three key benefits by implementing the below tips on feed segmentation, curated bundles, and disciplined bidding:



1



Margin Protection

Pushing high-AOV products such as gift sets prevents surging CPCs from wiping out margins.

2



Algorithmic Control

Custom labels stop automated bidding from burning peak spend on low-margin staples.

3



Faster Conversions

Synchronise ad creative with operational cutoffs to turn passive browsing into immediate, high-AOV orders before shipping windows close.



This approach will turn your peak ad spend into a **high-margin acquisition** engine through Q4.

WHAT'S INSIDE

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- 02 | Feed optimisation for festive and gifting intent
- 03 | Use seasonality adjustments and bid loosening tactically
- 04 | Capture high-intent non-brand queries with exact/phrase search frameworks
- 05 | Leverage Demand Gen to build brand consideration before peak clicks spike

01

Restructure Performance Max and feed segmentation with custom labels

Low-margin, single SKUs will drain budget as Shopping CPCs climb. Segment your product feeds in Google Merchant Center (GMC) to ensure Smart Bidding directs spend towards high-margin and festive inventory:

Custom Labels for Seasonality:

Tag products in your feed as Hero Festive, Gifting Bundles, High Margin, or All-Year Staples.

Tiered Campaign Architecture:

Break high-priority gifting bundles and party packs into dedicated Performance Max (PMax) campaigns with lower target ROAS (tROAS) to capture maximum impression share, whilst keeping core everyday essentials in a higher-tROAS evergreen campaign.

Feed-Only vs. Asset-Heavy PMax:

For pure product searches, test a feed-only PMax or asset group to maintain tight Shopping query matching, alongside separate asset groups built with lifestyle video and imagery targeting festive audience signals.

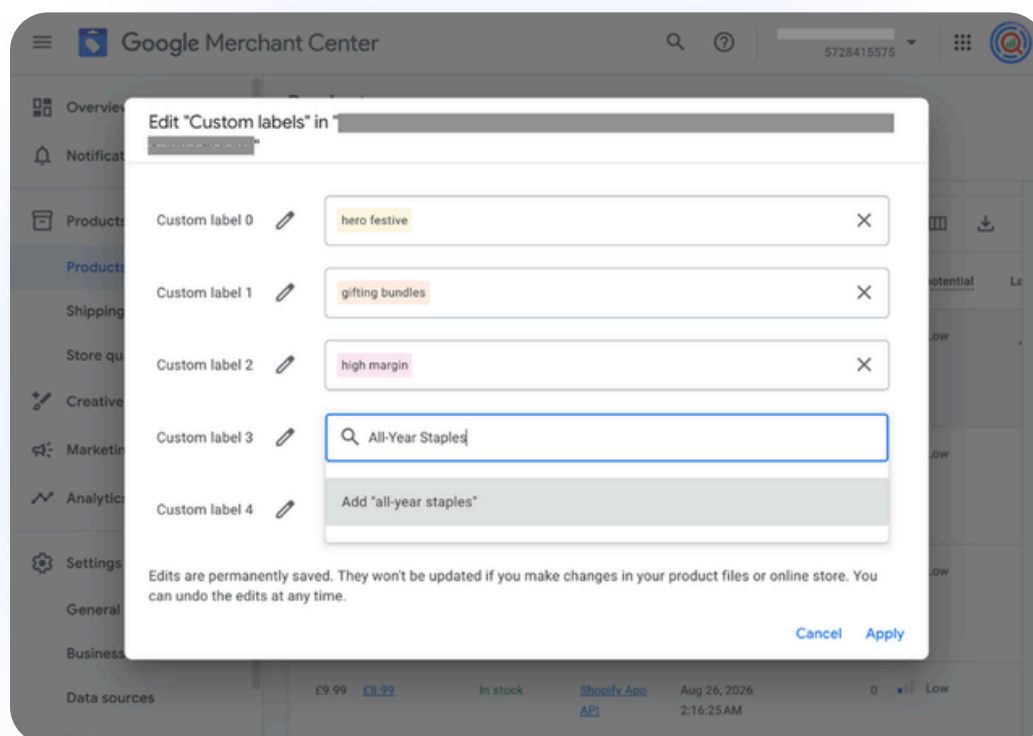


Figure 1 — Custom product labels in Google Merchant Center used to segment campaigns.

02

Feed Optimisation for Festive and Gifting Intent

Google Shopping algorithms rely heavily on structured text in product titles and descriptions. Front-load seasonal search intent directly into your GMC feed:

Front-Loaded Keyword Injection:

Modify festive SKU titles to lead with intent keywords, e.g. [Brand] + [Festive Gift Set / Advent Calendar / 12-Pack] + [Flavour/Variant] + [Volume/Size].

Merchant Center Promotions & Sale Badges:

Set up Merchant Promotions at least 72 hours ahead of key promotional windows (e.g. "Buy 2 Get 1 Free", "15% off hampers") to trigger the "Special Offer" tag on Search and Shopping grids.

Delivery & Shipping Annotations:

Configure fast and free shipping policies in GMC, highlighting guaranteed dispatch times to earn "Get it by [Date]" badges.

The screenshot shows the 'New promotion' interface in Google Merchant Center. The page has a header with a question mark icon, a user ID '536517182', and a menu icon. The main content area is titled 'Choose products' and 'Which products do you want to run this promotion for?'. There are three radio button options: 'Products selected for you' (selected), 'Use filters to indicate specific products, product types, or brands', 'Choose products from my data source that map to a specific promotion ID', and 'Promote all products'. Under the selected option, there is a box titled 'Selected for the promotion (100)' containing several product images and a '+94' button. To the right, there is a text box with a link to 'Review our implementation guide'. At the bottom, there is a 'Promotion title and ID' field with a placeholder 'Enter a title that describes your' and a '* Required field' label. Navigation buttons 'Back', 'Download', 'Save & add another', and 'Save' are at the bottom right.

Figure 2 — Setting up promotions in Google Merchant Center.

03

Use Seasonality Adjustments and Bid Loosening Tactically

Smart Bidding algorithms use historical conversion lag (typically 7–14 days) and may react too slowly to sudden spikes during Black Friday or December gifting peaks:

Seasonality Adjustments for Short Promos:

For rapid 2–5 day bursts (e.g. Cyber Weekend flash sales), proactively use the Google Ads Seasonality Adjustments tool to anticipate a 30–50%+ conversion rate uplift so the algorithm bids aggressively without hesitating.

Controlled tROAS Reductions:

For longer sales windows (e.g. the entire first two weeks of December), manually drop tROAS targets by 15–25% to open the bidding throttle and capture surging demand rather than being budget-capped.

Budget Headroom:

Ensure campaign budgets are set at least 20–30% above daily forecasted spend so high-converting campaigns never pause mid-afternoon during peak trading days.

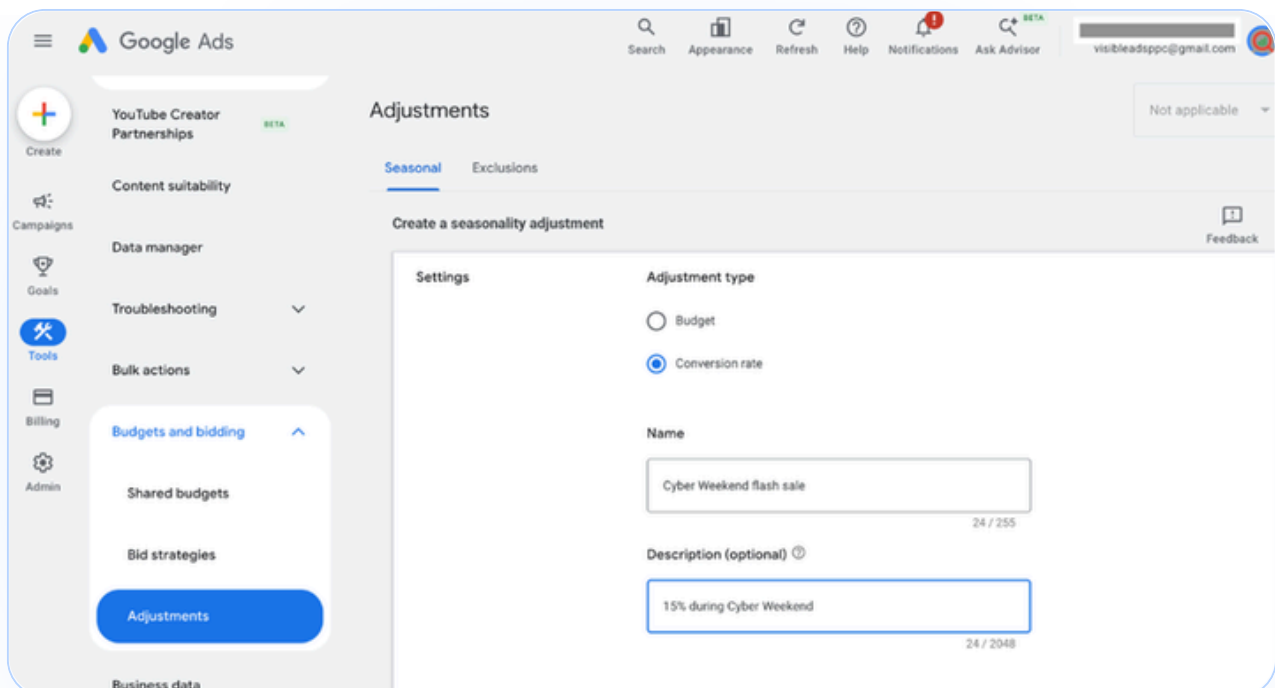


Figure 3 — Using seasonality adjustments for short-term bidding strategy overrides.

04

Capture High-Intent Non-Brand Queries with Exact/Phrase Search Frameworks

Whilst PMax covers broad discovery, dedicated Search campaigns prevent competitors from stealing high-value category and gifting traffic:

Category + Gifting Modifiers:

Build tight phrase-match search campaigns around high-intent FMCG terms, e.g. "artisan hot sauce gift set", "craft beer party pack", or "organic coffee hamper".

Negative Keywords:

Apply negative keyword lists to your Search campaigns (and campaign-level/account-level negative lists across PMax via Google support or account settings) specifically to block low-intent terms like "free samples", "recipes", or out-of-stock seasonal variations.

Ad Customiser Countdowns:

Deploy ad customisers in responsive search ads (RSAs) to dynamically display countdowns, e.g. "Christmas delivery ends in 3 days".

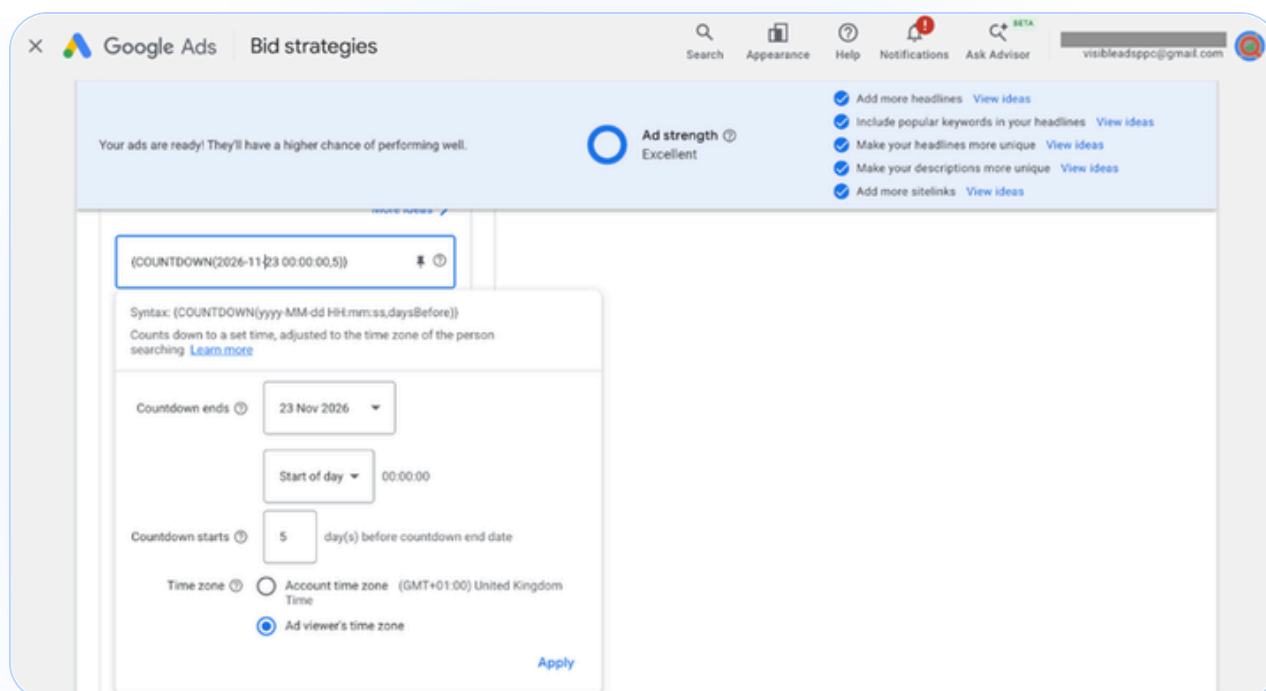


Figure 4 — Setting up countdowns in responsive search ad units.

05

Leverage Demand Gen to Build Brand Consideration Before Peak Clicks Spike

CPCs on Search and Shopping surge exponentially in late November and December. Use Demand Gen (YouTube Shorts, In-Feed, Gmail, and Discover) in October and early November to build low-cost reach:

Lookalikes of High-LTV Customers:

Upload hashed first-party customer lists (segmented by previous Q4 high spenders) and build 1–3% lookalike audiences across YouTube and Discover.

Appetite-Appeal Video Formats:

Use vertical short-form video (Shorts) showcasing taste tests, festive unboxings, or holiday cocktail and recipe pairings to drive high-intent visits at lower CPMs.

First-Party Audience Signals in PMax:

Feed these warm customer segments and website visitors directly back into your PMax asset groups as audience signals to accelerate learning during peak conversion windows.

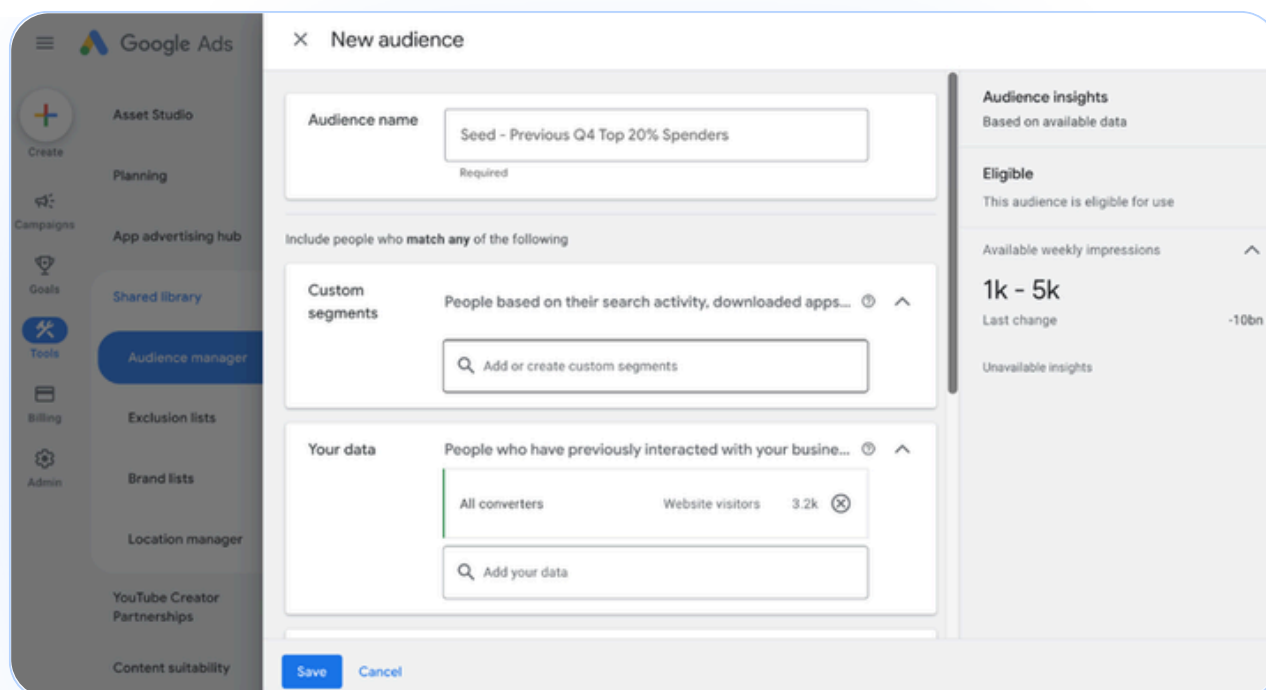


Figure 5 — Creating lookalike audiences based on previous high spenders.

WORK WITH US

Make this your most profitable Golden Quarter yet

Setting up feed segmentation, custom labels and advanced bidding controls ahead of peak season can make all the difference to your bottom line. The five tactics in this playbook work best when they are implemented together, in the right order, and with enough runway before CPCs spike.

If you want expert help fine-tuning your paid media architecture for Q4, get in touch with our team and we will build a high-performing roadmap for your brand.



WHAT A Q4 ENGAGEMENT LOOKS LIKE

01



Free account audit

A structural review of your Google, Shopping and PMax set-up, feed health and tracking — with the gaps ranked by revenue impact.

02



Peak-season roadmap

A week-by-week plan across feed, bidding, search and Demand Gen, built around your margins and stock position.

03



Profit-first management

Weekly budget decisions driven by POAS, with clear reporting and no cash burned on campaigns that do not return.



Book your **free** Q4 account audit


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visible-ads.com | London, UK


Three-month minimum term, then monthly rolling with 30 days' notice.

CASE STUDY

Chocolate Fountain Warehouse

UK's leading distributor of Sephra chocolate fountains and commercial food equipment.

- Food & Beverage Equipment
- Client since 2023


1,200%

ALL-TIME
ROAS


£6.00M

SALES
GENERATED


£500K

GOOGLE AD SPEND
MANAGED


180x

RETURN ON
AGENCY FEES



THE CHALLENGE

CFW had run Amazon and Google Ads campaigns for years with significant monthly investment, yet sales had flatlined. Campaigns were built around broad keywords that generated traffic without conversions, and nothing connected their Amazon and Google presence. The result was a cycle of rising spend against flat revenue, market share lost to competitors, and diminishing confidence that paid advertising could work at all.

WHAT WE DID

Account restructuring

Both the Google and Amazon accounts were rebuilt from scratch. Google campaigns moved to a category-Pmax structure with tightly themed ad groups allowing for individual budget control; Amazon Sponsored Products were separated by product category, each with its own bid strategy.

Product feed optimisation

Enriched product titles, detailed descriptions and accurate attributes lifted Google Shopping impression share by over 60% while reducing irrelevant clicks.

Amazon products & campaigns

Conversion-optimised listings, built sponsored product campaigns targeting high-converting long-tail keywords, Sponsored Brands for top-of-search visibility, defensive campaigns protecting branded terms, negative keyword lists and ROAS-based bidding.

ROAS-based scaling

Campaigns at or below break-even ROAS were gradually phased out. Campaigns outperforming target-ROAS were gently & continuously scaled.

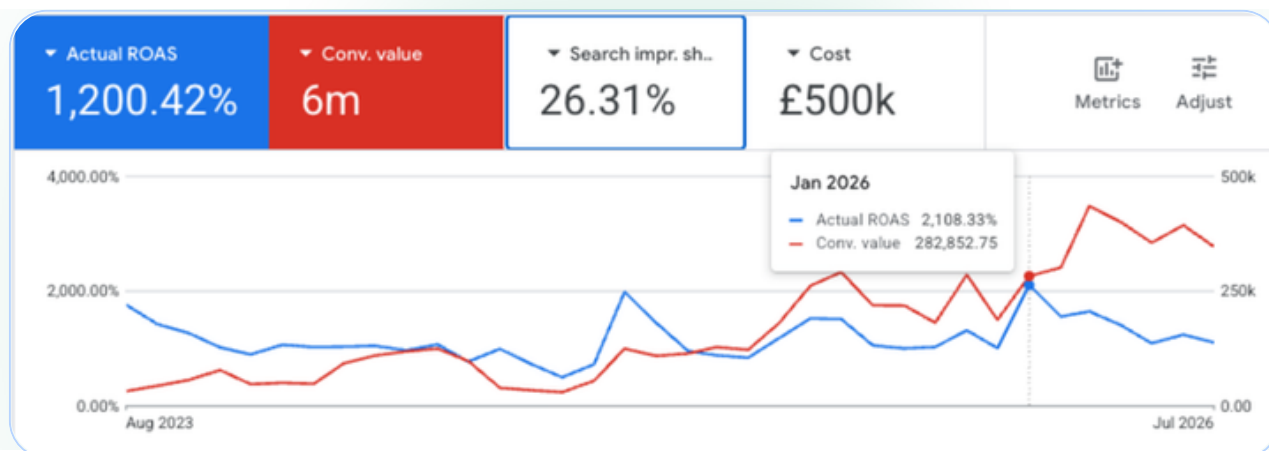
Continuous improvement

Non-stop testing across creative, campaign types, bidding strategies and keyword structures.

• Services: **Google Ads** · **Amazon Ads** · **eCRO**



THE RESULTS



Daily spend: Scaled from £60/day to over £1,000/day (a 17X increase).

Monthly revenue: Grew ad-attributed sales from £30k/month to over £350k/month

Peak performance: Hit an incredible 2,108% (21X) ROAS in January 2026.

Lifetime ad-attributed sales: £6M+ generated directly from paid search.



The work was shortlisted at the **UK eCommerce Awards in 2024** and again at the **National Digital Awards in 2026**.



"Overall, our experience with Visible Ads has been exceptional since 2023. Their commitment to delivering results, professionalism, and expertise has made them a trusted partner in our business growth."

David Archer Managing Director, Chocolate Fountain Warehouse

ABOUT US

About Visible Ads

We are a London-based team of e-commerce ads specialists managing £3M in annual ad spend. We are certified experts and award winners — and we shift the focus from vanity metrics to Profit on Ad Spend.

**Our mission**

Empowering brands to scale sustainably by shifting the focus from vanity metrics to a high Profit on Ad Spend.

WHO WE ARE



Founder-led team - Specialised in profitable, cross-channel campaigns — Google, Meta, Amazon, TikTok, LinkedIn and more.



£3M managed annually - With multiple industry awards, shortlistings and nominations to show for it.



We grow with our clients - Long-term partnerships rather than short campaign bursts.

WHO WE WORK WITH

**D2C & B2B FMCG**

E-commerce

**UK, US & EU**

Cross-border, multi-market accounts

**£1–20M revenue**

Annual turnover of our typical client

PROBLEMS WE SOLVE



Visibility

We take stores from invisible to visible, so more of your ideal customers find your product — more sales from less ad spend.



Sales & Leads

We continuously increase conversion rates and scale ads profitably.



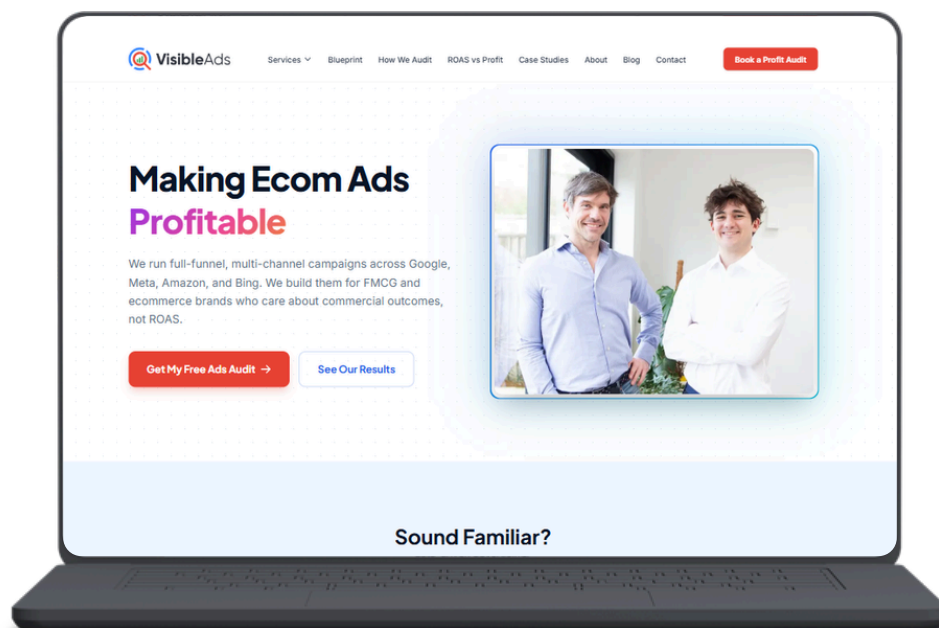
Attribution

We work out which channel is genuinely driving revenue, and fund it accordingly.

HOW WE SCALE AD SPEND

We never burn cash. We respond to demand by adapting campaign budgets weekly, which stabilises Profit on Ad Spend and keeps campaigns profitable as conditions change.

WEEKLY / MONTHLY ROAS		ACTION
Above 1,200%	>	Add 20% budget per week
900% – 1,100%	>	Add 10% budget per week
600% – 800%	>	Hold budget steady
300% – 500%	>	Reduce budget by 20%
Below 300%	>	Switch the campaign off



WORK WITH US

**Let's scale your revenue with
PPC — profitably.**



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